

Iris SooJin Park

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Education

University of Wisconsin–Madison,

Ph.D. Candidate, Insurance Economics and Actuarial Analytics	Expected 05/2027
B.A., Economics with Mathematical Emphasis (Honors), GPA: 4.00/4.00	2021
B.A., Mathematics, GPA: 3.97/4.00	2021

Graduated with Distinction

Research Interests

Insurance economics; health economics; Behavioral economics

Working Papers

- “Do Patients Respond to the Right Price? Myopia and Price Misperception in Health Insurance”
Job Market Paper
- “The Generosity Paradox: When Less Generous Insurance Raises Spending” [\[PDF\]](#)
Under Review
- “The Impact of Decision Aids on Health Insurance Selection” *with Justin Sydnor and Ayna Samek* [\[PDF\]](#)
 - ***Rising Financial Literacy Scholar Award***, 2026 Stanford Financial Education Symposium
- “To Smooth or Not to Smooth: Consumption Responses to Life Insurance Payouts ” *with Tyler Welch*

Works in Progress

- “How Information Display Affects Health Insurance Decisions” *with Justin Sydnor and Yuxin Wen*
- “Older Americans and Life Insurance” *with Tyler Welch* [\[Working Draft\]](#)
- “When Work Injury Claims Don’t Work: Welfare Consequences of Shifting Care Between Workers’ Compensation and Health Insurance” *with Jonghwa Do and Tyler Welch*
- “Endogenous Spending and Labor Supply Responses to Health Shocks” *with Laura Waring*

Publications

Park, S., & Deller, S. (2021). “Effect of farm structure on rural community well-being.” *Journal of Rural Studies*, 87, 300–313. *Research conducted as an undergraduate.*

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Prof. Justin Sydnor	2022–2025
Research Assistant, Prof. Steven Deller	2019–2021
Data Analyst Intern, Madison Region Economic Partnership	2020
Research Assistant, Korea Research Institute for Human Settlements (KRIHS)	2019

Presentations

American Risk and Insurance Association Annual Meeting, Orlando, FL	2026
Stanford Financial Education Symposium, Stanford, CA	2026
Behavioral Science and Health Symposium, Philadelphia, PA	2025
Stanford University, Health Econ Problem Solving Group, Stanford, CA	2025
UGA Ph.D. Student Research Symposium, Athens, GA	2025
American Risk and Insurance Association Annual Meeting, Denver, CO	2024
Southern Regional Science Association 60th Annual Meeting (Virtual)	2021
Undergraduate Symposium (Virtual)	2021

Policy Reports and Other Writing

“High Deductible Health Plan Initiative Research Reports.” for the State of Wisconsin Group Health Insurance Board Meeting – [3 Part Report](#)

- Report on Health Care Utilization Differences between IYC Health Plan and HDHP Enrollees.
- Report on Projecting Member Costs in the HDHP vs. IYC Health Plan.
- Report on Health Plan Choice Study

“Is Bigger Better? Farm Size and Community Well-Being.” *The Daily Yonder*, 2021

“Healthcare Industry Cluster.” Sector Abstracts, Madison Region Economic Partnership, 2019

Honors, Awards, and Grants

Grants

Faculty & Graduate Student Research Grant, BRITE Lab	2025
Student Research Grant, University of Wisconsin–Madison	Aug 2024
Travel Award, Wisconsin School of Business	Aug 2024, 2025, 2026

Awards

Rising Financial Literacy Scholar Award, Stanford Financial Education Symposium	Apr 2026
3MT Semi-finals Competition Finalist	Nov 2025
Trewartha Senior Honors Thesis Award	2021
Dean’s Honors List, University of Wisconsin–Madison	2017–2021

Scholarships and Fellowships

George Fait Insurance Scholarship	Aug 2025
Graduate Scholarship, Wisconsin School of Business	2021–2025
Hilldale Undergraduate/Faculty Research Fellowship	2020

Workshops

Financial Literacy Research Boot Camp	2025
Hosted by G53 Network and Stanford University's Initiative for Financial Decision-Making	

Reviewer Service

Journal of Risk and Insurance

Service

Committee Member, PhD Student Committee on Inclusion, Wisconsin School of Business	2024–
Present	
Outreach Assistant, <i>Journal of Risk and Insurance</i>	2021–2022

Memberships

American Risk and Insurance Association	2024–Present
American Economic Association	2019–Present

Other Information

Citizenship: South Korea

Languages: English (fluent), Korean (native), Mandarin (basic)